

Samsung Galaxy Buds 4 Pro

A strong premium pick, especially for Galaxy users

I have been a longtime Samsung Galaxy Buds 2 user, and it works great with my Galaxy S23. So, when I got the Galaxy Buds 4 Pro from the brand, I switched. I have been using the newcomer for a few weeks now, and although my first 24-hour impressions have been positive but incomplete, I now have a lot more to share. The new pair is priced at Rs 22,999, and Samsung is pitching it as its premium earbuds for the year with a dual-driver setup, enhanced ANC, and deeper integration with Galaxy devices through high-resolution audio support and easy software customisation. And so the test was to see how well it competes in this price range.

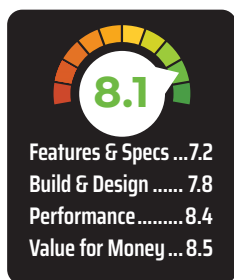
The Samsung Galaxy Buds 4 Pro have been my close companion for a week, and here's my review of how they fare in sound quality, noise handling, battery life, connectivity, and overall usability in the real world.

DESIGN AND COMFORT

As mentioned in my first impressions piece, the Galaxy Buds 4 Pro have a distinct design. That includes its squircle case with a transparent lid and the earbuds themselves with their flat stem and brushed metal finish. The buds look new due to this finish and like I said in my impressions, the case has a jewellery-box-like aesthetic, which by the way, is a bit thick but won't hamper everyday portability.

The earbuds are quite lightweight and stay securely in the ear. These are among the few earbuds I felt comfortable wearing during commute.

₹22,999



Samsung offers its premium earbuds in multiple colours: The black colour that we have, a white variant and a pink gold option for a warm and elegant look.

Samsung's case has the brand logo and an LED indicator on the front, and the back has a USB-C port and a pairing/resetting button.

The case is not easy to open one-handed, the lid opening and closing feels more premium and satisfying.

Besides looks and comfort, the Galaxy Buds 4 Pro pinch and swipe-based controls are easy to manoeuvre. I feel this approach is better than the tap/press-based controls, as you don't have

to push the earbuds deeper into the ear. For durability assurance, Samsung Galaxy Buds 4 Pro are IP57 rated, which means they can take some rain, sweat, splash and even accidental submersion.

CONNECTIVITY AND PERFORMANCE

I paired the Galaxy Buds 4 Pro with my Galaxy S23, a Pixel 10, and my MacBook Air 13. No issues with the setup process. In everyday use, the general connectivity and range were stable over Bluetooth 6.1.

Once set up, on Samsung phones like the Galaxy S23, you can control the earbuds' settings through the Bluetooth menu itself. And on non-Samsung phones, you'll have to access the settings through the Wearables app and the Galaxy Buds module, both of which are available on the Google Play Store.

The Samsung phones also offer more features like 360 audio, loudness normalisation, Ultra High Quality (24-bit/96kHz audio via Samsung's codec), Adapt Sound, and app sound settings. This isn't a deal breaker though, as their absence doesn't spoil the Buds 4 Pro sound experience.

There are ample toggles and controls in the Wearables app. My only qualm is that the pinch and hold controls are limited to switching noise modes, triggering Google and opening Spotify. I would appreciate it if Samsung added an option to change volume or playback with this action. The pinch and swipe controls are intuitive enough, but I don't mind more options. Samsung software is known for an abundance of options.

The one feature I miss the most is standard Bluetooth multipoint. Samsung allow auto switching, but it works between devices signed in the same Samsung account. This affects users who work across non-Samsung setups.

Other features, like in-ear detection, 360 Sound with head tracking, Auracast, the 9-band equaliser, and the different preset profiles, worked reliably. I appreciate it for the Loudness Normalisation and the Adapt Sound option, as I'll take anything that saves my ear health.